Nivolumab, pemetrexed and cisplatin before surgery

Up to three 21-day cycles. Day 1: nivolumab, pemetrexed and cisplatin. Then surgical MDT reassessment. The five listed backbones are alternatives; this guide covers only your selected combination.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hormones / energy

Nivolumab

Report severe tiredness, headache, dizziness or unusual thirst.

2 Breathing

Nivolumab

Report new cough, breathlessness or chest pain urgently.

3 Liver

Nivolumab / chemotherapy

Blood tests check liver function; report yellow eyes or dark urine.

4 Bowels

Nivolumab / chemotherapy

Report persistent diarrhoea, blood, pain or inability to drink.

5 Kidneys / urine

Nivolumab / cisplatin

Blood tests check kidney function; report reduced urine.

6 Blood / infection

pemetrexed / cisplatin

Fever or sudden illness can be an emergency; follow your contact plan.

7 Skin / hair

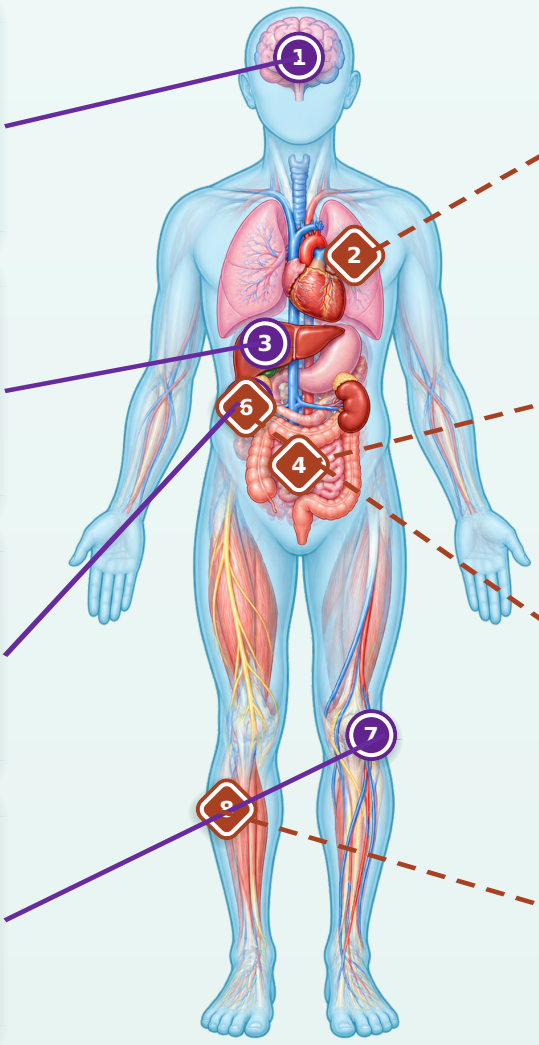
pemetrexed / nivolumab

Report a severe rash or blistering urgently; hair changes vary.

8 Nerves / hearing

pemetrexed / cisplatin

Report new numbness, tingling, tinnitus or hearing change.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact your oncology team urgently for fever, feeling suddenly unwell, new breathlessness, chest pain, persistent diarrhoea, severe weakness, confusion, reduced urine or a severe rash. Follow your local emergency instructions; do not wait for the next appointment.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Nivolumab

- Immune inflammation in multiple organs
- Infusion reactions
- Delayed effects after treatment stops

Pemetrexed

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Mouth soreness and diarrhoea
- Kidney problems
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Skin rash; rarely serious skin reactions
- Rare serious lung inflammation

Cisplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Mouth soreness and diarrhoea
- Kidney problems
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Hearing changes or tinnitus, which can persist
- Numbness or tingling, which can persist
- Electrolyte changes and need for hydration

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Your written prevention plan

Take the prescribed folic acid, vitamin B12 and rash-prevention steroid plan; continue folic acid for 21 days after the final pemetrexed dose. Cisplatin needs hydration, electrolyte checks and monitoring of kidneys, hearing and nerves.

Immune alert card

Nivolumab can inflame healthy organs during treatment or after it stops. Report new symptoms promptly and carry your immune alert card for at least five months after the last dose.

Prepare for surgery

The oncology and surgical teams agree scans, recovery checks and timing. Report any illness or new symptom before the planned operation.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00849/backbone_00317/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.